



Scientist Ayyalusamy Ramamoorthy of Michigan has found the secret behind turmeric's healing power (*Journal of the American Chemical Society*, April 2009). The molecules of *haldi* act like a "biochemical disciplinarian", he claims. They insert themselves into cell membranes and make them more stable and orderly, in a way that increases cells' resistance to infection by disease-causing microbes.



UPdates

A group of doctors from Bombay Hospital has formed India's first bone marrow donor registry to help patients in need of transplants.

Sir Ganga Ram Hospital, Delhi, has adopted the world's fastest database to reduce outpatient processing time by 40 per cent.

For greater insight into your child's mind, Dr Sanjay Chugh of New Delhi is holding counselling sessions with parents. Ph: 41436012 / 41436013

Are you wearing the right shoes?

75% people don't, say podiatrists. Some tips for footwear shopping

An ordinary day's walking brings a force of several hundred tons to bear on your feet. And your feet walk about 1,600 km a year.

Go footwear shopping at the end of the day, when your feet are at their largest.

Go for seamless shoes or make sure that the seams don't rub against your feet.

Wrong shoes can give you a range of suffering—corns, ingrown toenails to arthritis, nerve and circulatory disorders

The heel counter should be stiff yet sufficiently cushioned, so that your feet don't slip out while walking.

High-heeled or pointed-toe footwear put pressure on the joints of your toes. Do not wear heels that are higher than 2.5 inches.

The sole should be cushioned for support and to allow toes to bend as you walk.

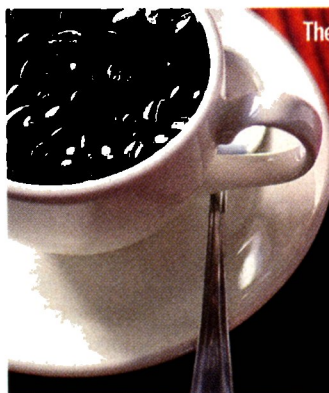
The area around the toe shouldn't be too deep or too wide. Look for a gap of 0.5 inch between the longest toe and the end of the shoe. You should be able to wiggle your toes inside.

Always buy shoes that feel most comfortable on the larger foot.

Buy shoes that are comfortable when you first try them on. Don't expect them to stretch with time.



Coffee is now the new health food



The real impact comes from drinking at least two mugs a day, say medics

- Contains antioxidants that fight cell damage and lower Type 2 diabetes risk by 28%
- Cuts heart disease risk by 24%; stroke by 20%
- Drinkers 80% less likely to develop Alzheimer's, Parkinson's and dementia
- Reduces colon cancer by 25%, liver cirrhosis by 80%, gallstone risk by 50%
- Lowers cavity risk; kills mouth bacteria by 40%

THINK BEFORE YOU DROP A DRESS SIZE

Losing as little as 5 kg, or one dress size, can age a person by four years, while those with chubby cheeks look younger. It's not wrinkles that make you look older, but changes in face shape, claim US scientists. A classic case: Angelina Jolie, before and after significant weight-loss.



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